



nation is designed to reduce distortion and improve efficiency. They support LHDC 5.0 Hi-Res audio and can provide 24-bit/96kHz streaming over Bluetooth.

Noise has also partnered with Bose for sound tuning. I used the earbuds in the Sound by Bose EQ profile only. I was listening mostly at 60-80% volume with ANC on. I used a pair of OnePlus earbuds in the sub-Rs 7,000 price range for comparable testing. The Noise earbuds aren't as loud as the OnePlus pair.

The bass is present with ample oomph and rumble. But, while listening to Ari Ari from Dhurandhar 2, I noticed the beats and drops in the track sounded tighter and fuller in the OnePlus pair. But as a standalone pair, Master Buds 2 can give you an enjoyable time in pop and electronic tracks.

The vocals are clear and forward. This could come in handy when listening to songs, podcasts, dialogue-heavy movies, etc. The instruments were also clear, although sometimes they felt thin. This is evident in the presentation of violin strings in Stumble Then Rise by Silver Mt Zion. In this track, the high notes are also very audible.

In similar tracks with complex instrument play, sounds start to feel compressed together. But considering the price they are coming for, that's not a biggie.

Last but not least, Noise has added another special feature for its Master series users within the Noise Audio app: Spatial audio with head tracking. They give you a feeling of audio anchored to the source device. It is fun, but I don't

enjoy listening like that for long. But you may like it. I'd say it is worth trying for the curiosity alone.

REASONABLE ANC AND CALL QUALITY

The Master Buds 2 offer adaptive active noise cancellation rated at up to 51dB. The adaptive mode works, but I chose to use the Max ANC setting because the adaptive mode kept changing the noise cancellation in a distracting way.

I wore it in the office, at home, while commuting in the metro, in auto rickshaws, and the ANC on the Buds 2 performs quite well for everyday environments. It does not completely eliminate all sound, especially sudden or sharp noises, but it significantly lowers the overall noise level. And that is what I want from an ANC earbud.

I can't share the same satisfaction with Transparency mode. It allows outside sound to pass, more than the Noise Cancellation Off mode, but the sound wasn't very natural. I used it to stay aware of my surroundings, on less busy roads, but didn't feel like using it for long.

As for calls, the experience was fine. Both parties could hear each other clearly, and the six-mic system with ENC algorithms does a good job of filtering out moderate background noise.

BATTERY LIFE AND CHARGING

With ANC off, the earbuds lasted around 6.5 hours in our battery drain test. The music was continuously playing at 80% volume on my Galaxy

S23 (source device). With the case, the brand claims around 30 hours of playtime. The mileage would vary if you use ANC.

Still at moderate volume, I figure you could comfortably get through most of a workday without worrying about battery life.

The earbuds also support fast charging. A full 0 to 100 top-up is rated to take around 1.5 hours. The company also says a quick 10-minute charge can provide up to six hours of playback with ANC off.

The charging case uses a USB Type-C port, in case you are wondering.

SHOULD YOU BUY NOISE MASTER BUDS 2?

The Noise Master Buds 2 try to do a lot, and to some extent, they succeed. After using them across work, commute, and casual listening, they come across as a fairly well-rounded pair, but not without a few rough edges.

—G. S. Vasan

SPECIFICATIONS

Driver: 10 mm dynamic | Tuning: Sound by Bose | ANC: Upto 51dB | Mic: 6-mic ENC system | Audio: LHDC Hi-Res Audio | Connectivity: Bluetooth v6.1 | Battery: 6 hrs per charge (30hrs with case) | IP rating: IPX5

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